

Chapter 1

4

Define risk factor

Risk factors is an exposure to something that is associated with a disease, morbidity, mortality, or other adverse health outcome.

What are some examples of risk factors that you experience in your life?

One of the big things in my life is I eat a lot of foods high in sugar and highly processed, which is a risk factor for things like obesity and diabetes. To mitigate this risk factor I try to exercise frequently.

Another risk factor in my life is I participate in Judo club where we practice a lot of Judo and Jujitsu. These sports are close contact and we practice on old wrestling mats. There is a wide variety of risk factors associated with this sport because of a lot of close contact with other people (so if someone is sick many people can get sick) and the mats could be dirty as well allowing germs to spread when rolling on them. To mitigate these risk factors, the club asks that people do not roll if they are sick, we also clean the mats before and after using them, and everyone is strongly advised to thoroughly shower after the club meeting is over.

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What are four uses of epidemiology? (AND RANK THEM)

On the slides the listed uses of epidemiology are as follows: Historical, Community Health, Health Services, Risk Assessment, and Disease Causality.

1. Disease Causality: Determining the causes of diseases by analyzing the experiences and environment of the infected population. An example of this is John Snow using disease causality to determine that cholera was caused by the infected water well.
2. Health Services: Studying the current state of health services and ways to improve their effectiveness. The example given in the slides is optimizing the placement of health services to increase the total coverage of areas but another metric that could be studied is the average duration patients are in the hospital to determine the efficiency of an individual health service area.
3. Risk Assessment: Determining an individual's risk of disease / accident / negative health outcome and trying to prevent / mitigate these outcomes. An example of this is at a yearly doctor checkup they know your medical history and the medical history of your family and if say diabetes runs in the family they can check you for diabetes while also offer ways to prevent you from getting diabetes.

4. Community Health: The analysis of current overall health of the community using a variety of census statistics. An example of this could be a report of flu cases near college campuses spiking during the winter then suddenly dropping during winter break (because students left campus area to go home).

Why did you rank them in that order?

I ordered them based on my opinion on 2 factors: impact scale (individuals vs communities vs global) and use type (analytical, preventative, mitigative). For ordering, I think that the impact scale is ordered by more people means more important, and for use type my order is 1. preventative, 2. mitigative, 3. analytical because I believe that preventing a disease from spreading is more important than mitigating the effects of a disease. In my opinion the disease causality use is the number one because its impact scale is number 1 and its use type is both preventative and mitigative. Health Services is both preventative and mitigative as well but mainly looks at communities. Risk assessment is at an individual scale and is preventative and mitigative use types. Lastly community health is last because it is community level and is mostly analytical which in my opinion is the least important use type.

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Why do people regard John Snow as the Father of epidemiology? Provide 3 reasons

Chapter 2

2

What is Quantitative Data?

Quantitative data is numerable / orderable data that can be represented with numbers and strictly ordered.

What is Qualitative Data?

Qualitative data is categorical data where the data is put into different categories.

Categorize the following parameters:

- Sex

Qualitative

- Race

Qualitative

- Weight

Quantitative

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Define the following and cite their applications

1. Stratified random sampling
2. Systemic sampling
3. Convenience sampling
4. Cluster sampling

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Why is random sampling unbiased?

Samples are selected via a random process thus are unbiased because the samples aren't clustered around any particular group.

Chapter 3

7

How are incidence and prevalence related to each other?

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What quantitative measure is shown in the table (3.3)?

Describe the annual trends in the case of infrequently reported notifiable diseases

Why do we have to be careful about comparing counts across different populations?

Different populations have different levels of normal expectancy of certain diseases. For example, a certain population might have a malaria Endemic (high rates of malaria is normal for the population) while other populations might not have a malaria Endemic. This could be due to a wide variety of factors such as presence of mosquitos within the population.

Problem

Calculate the Incidence Rate

$$\frac{\# \text{ of incidents}}{\# \text{ of ppl}} \times 100,000 = \frac{441}{11.42 \times 10^6} \times 100,000 = 3.8616 \text{ per } 100,000$$

Calculate the Fatality Rate

$$\frac{\# \text{ of deaths}}{\# \text{ of cases}} = \frac{31}{441} * 100 = 7.029$$